

Mata o Muna 7 / Chapter 7

Faifaiga i Loto i te Kāiga / Family Customs and Traditions

Te Gagana Tuvalu	English
Faiga o Āvaga	Marriage
A te faiga o te āvaga e mai lalo ailoa i te pule a mātua o tuku a te taliaga ke fai a te āvaga a te lā tama, kae ko mātua hoki ailoa fakatahi mo te kāiga o filifili a te āvaga a te olotou tamaliki tagata. E i ai hoki ailoa he avanoaga o te tamaliki tagata o fakailoa ki ona mātua a te fafine telā e fiafai kāiga a ia ki ai. A te tamaliki fafine e mafai hoki o fakailoa ki ona kāiga/mātua me talia, me hē talia e ia o āvaga ki te tagata telā ni avatu a tana fekau e ona kāiga. Kae i te tonuga, a te tamaliki tagata e 'tau o fakamāhāni muamua ki te tamaliki fafine, kae ke talitonu a ia me koa talia a tana fekau manafai e avatu. Kae fai la koa fakatau loto ma'lie katoa a te kāiga ki ai, koa mafai ai o fakataunugina a te mea tenei ko te āvaga.	Parents normally give permission for their children to marry, and parents together with other family members select a wife for their son. There is also an opportunity for the son to make known to his parents whom he would like to marry. A woman also may tell her family whether she agrees to marry a particular man or not, after the man's family has brought a proposal. However, a man usually only suggests that his family make a proposal after he himself has personally approached the young woman and she has agreed. Provided that everyone agrees, what is called marriage can proceed.
Kae fai hoki pelā e i ai he fifiga, e mafai hoki ailoa a kau kāiga e lua o oko atu ki he tulaga e tai fakamataku. A lāua konei kolā koa 'loto ma'lie ke fai a telā kāiga, kae koa hē mafai o fakataunugina i te mea ko loto o kāiga, e mafai e lāua konei o faka'tupu ni fakalavelave kolā e tafahili a te fakafanoanoa ki alā kāiga.	If there is a difficulty, the two families can experience a threatening situation. These two who hope to marry each other but are prevented by family opposition can cause a problem that is especially sad to their families.
A lāua konei koa loto ke fai a telā kāiga, e 'tau ke noho a te tino e tahi ki te tua-fā kae tokotahi ki te tua-tolu, kae heiloga lā koa 'mate a mātua o he toko tahi o lāua konei, koa mafai i ai o āvaga a te tua-tolu ki te tua-tolu.	For people wishing to marry each other, one of them must be no more closely related than fourth cousin and the other can be third cousin, unless the parents of one of them have died, and then third cousins can marry each other.
'Kavega o te Fekau	Making the Proposal
Koa maua nei a te tamafine ke fai mo āvaga a te tamaliki tagata, telā lā ko mātua o te tamaliki tagata me he tokolua o tino fakamātuatua o te kāiga e mafai o olo o 'kave a te fekau a te olotou tamaliki tagata ki mātua o te tamaliki fafine. A te tali, e mafai o talia ka e mafai hoki o hē talia. Kae fai lā e manuia ni talia a te fekau, ko te taimi lā tenā koa mafaufau i ai a mātua, ia me ko kau kāiga, ki te taimi e tuhi i ai a te āvaga, ki	Once the future wife of the son has been agreed on, his parents or two older members of his family can go to the parents of the girl to ask permission. The answer could be positive or it might be negative. If the proposal succeeds, both parents and their families decide when to register the

te leva telā e toka 'lei i ai a fakatokatokaga a kāiga kae koi tuai o faipoipo.

engagement, depending on how much time the families need for their preparations.

Tuhiga o te Āvaga

I pō mua a te āvaga e mafai o tuhi ki te mahina-tahi, mahina-lua me ki te mahina-tolu, e faka'tau ailoa ki te toka 'lei a mea a kaukāiga e lua. I te tuhiga o te āvaga ko lāua konei koa fai a te lā āvaga fakatahi mo lā tauhoa (uosili) e olo ki te ofisa o te failautuhi o te fenua o fakamaoni kae o saina hoki i ai a te tuhiga o te āvaga.

Writing the Engagement

Formerly, a marriage could be proposed one, two, or three months in advance, the time depending only on the amount of time needed for proper completion of preparations by the two families. Registering the engagement involves the couple and their attendants (tauhoa) going to the Government Secretary's office to witness the signing of their intent to marry.

Fakatokatokaga a Kau Kāiga

Mai te taimi tenei koa oti i ai ni tuhi a te āvaga, ko kāiga hoki ailoa koa kāmata o galue'lue kae o fakatokatoka a mea kolā e fai i te taimi o te faipoipoga:

- E lahi a te halagā-ika e fakatāuagina, kae mailoga ko ika moana pelā mo atu, takuo mo hahave. E fakamasima kae fakapaku'paku, e pelā hoki a ika ake.
- Ka tausi faka'lei a niu fai kaulōlō.
- A te tamana koa pula faka'lei ki ana talo/pulaka kolā e 'tau o 'ta i te taimi o te faipoipoga.
- A te mātua, fakatahi mo ona fakataina, ailoa tenā te haga mo te faiga o mea 'laga (takai) mo 'laga epa, pelā hoki mo te faiga o galegale mo fai a te teu galegale o te fale, pelā hoki mo titi galegale.
- Tuagane mo fakatuagane o te tamaliki tagata e māhane o takitahi a olotou papa mo fai a te nohoaga o te āvaga fou.
- E i ai hoki ni lua fāfine e ailoa a haga mo te tuituiga o lava mo hulu 'fou o te āvagafou mo lā tauhoa (uosili).

Preparations of the Two Families

After registering the engagement, both families begin to work to prepare the many things that are needed for the wedding:

- Much effort is spent on fishing, especially ocean fish such as tuna, yellowfin and flying fish. These are salted or dried, as are other fish.
- Big clusters of coconuts are well looked after.
- The fathers must carefully prepare taro and pulaka to harvest for the wedding.
- The mothers, together with their female cousins, have several important duties: to prepare pandanus weaving materials and to use them to weave fine mats, to make coloured pandanus strips to decorate the houses, and to make colourful titi galegale skirts.
- Sisters and opposite sex cousins of the groom usually provide one papa mat each to make the couple's raised wedding seat.
- In both families, several women are given the special assignment of sewing new clothes and hulu sarongs for the couple and their attendants.

Atafata ko te Faipoipoga

A te māhane o āvaga i pō mua, e faipoipo tele ailoa i pō tolu, telā lā ko mea katoa kolā e fakatokagina mo te taimi o te faipoipoga e 'tau katoa o 'luku i te pō lua. He pō e tafahili i te fakalavelave a te pō tenei ko te pō lua me ko te fakatokatokaga o meakai mo te pō atafata:

- Tino e olo ki Lakena (he motu o Nanumea) o 'ta pulaka.

The Day Before the Wedding

In the past, weddings always took place on Wednesday, and thus everything needed for the wedding had to be gathered together by Tuesday. Tuesday would always be a very busy day because of all the preparation of food for the wedding day:

- People go to Lakena to harvest pulaka and taro.

- Tino e olo o 'kati kaulōlō, kake pī, oka niu.
- Tamatāne e olo ki moana, tino ake e olo o tā tili, kae ke toka hoki a lātou o 'ta a puaka i te pogipogi 'malu.
- Tamatāne/tamāfine e holopulaka kae valu niu mo fai a te lolo o te fekei me he fakalala, telā e fai ailoa ke pī a te tānoa mo 'kai a kāiga.
- Ke oko hoki ki fāfine tai mātua'tua koa kāmata hoki o fakagaligali a te fale i te afiāfi tenei, 'tau a te teu galegale, kae 'fola a te fale ki kapau 'fou, papa 'fou, pelā hoki mo te fakatokaga o te nohoaga o te āvaga fou.

- People cut down clusters of drinking nuts by lowering them whole, climb for individual drinking nuts and husk brown mature coconuts.
- Young men go out fishing in the ocean, other men net fish, and still others get ready to slaughter pigs in the early morning.
- Young men and women grate pulaka and coconut to make lolo (coconut cream) for fekei and fakalala puddings, filling the long wooden basins that will be needed to feed everyone.
- Older women begin to decorate the house this evening, tying on galegale strips of coloured pandanus, spreading out a new carpet of kapau under-mats then new papa mats on top of them, preparing the raised wedding seat for the newlyweds.

Alānei ko te Faipoipoga

I te pogipogi 'malu o te pō tenei, a kāiga o te tagata, pelā hoki mo kāiga o te fāfine koa kāmata nei o teu a olotou tamaliki mo lā tauhoa (uosili), ko te mea ailoa koa olo o solo kae uhuu hu pehe, siva i te auala, ke oko ailoa ki te taimi e kini mai ai a te pele koa olo i ai ki loto i te faletapu.

Oti a te lotu koa toe 'foki atu i ai a lātou konei ki olotou fale, koa kāmata i ai o teu (lākei) a te āvaga fou mo alā tauhoa ki tēuga ailoa faka te fenua kolā ni fakatokagina e olā mātuafo.

Koa fakatoka atu nei mo te 'kāiga lahi o te āvaga fou; taumātua mo lōmātua i te fale o te tagata koa 'noho nei i olotou nohoaga fakapogai. A te tamaliki tagata e ana a te āvaga mo tona tauhoa koa 'noho nei i te nohoaga o te āvagafou telā ni fakatokagina e fai-tuagane e o ia.

Ko tamātane tuputupu e pukepuke e lātou a meakai, mo fāfine e mako'mako mai mua; kae ko te kau kāiga katoa ka olo atu i te taimi nei ki te fale o te tagata, kae mai mua o lātou konei ko te tamaliki fāfine mo tana tauhoa e amoamo a te lā kete koa oti ni 'fao ki ika paku'paku kae fakagaligali ki takataka 'kula.

Koa tu atu nei he tino tai fakamātuatua mai te kāiga o te tagata o fai he ana lāuga fakafetai ki te kāiga o te fāfine, fakatahi i ai mo te fakatokaga ki te 'kāiga lahi i te tutonu. Koi tuai o fai te 'kāiga, mātuafo o te tamafāfine, pelā hoki mātuafo o te tama tagata, koa huihui a manogi o lā tamafo.

The Day of the Wedding

At dawn on this day, both the groom's family and the family of the bride begin to adorn their children and the tauhoa attendants so that they can go in procession, singing songs and dancing through the streets. When the church bell rings, the couple and their tauhoa go into the church for the blessing service.

Afterwards, the bride and groom each return back to their own homes. Their volunteer mothers (matua ofo) are waiting there to adorn (lakei) them and their attendants with the titi and flower head wreaths that they have prepared.

The big wedding feast is now being readied. Male and female elders of the groom's family take their special seats in the groom's house. The groom and his best man are seated on the wedding dais prepared by his female cousins.

Their strong young men carry the food and some women dance along in front of them. In front of them is the bride and her maid of honour, carrying their kete basket filled with dried fish (ika pakupaku) and decorated with aged red takataka kula coconut.

When the visitors are settled, an elder from the groom's family stands up to make a speech welcoming the bride's family. Before the noon feast begins, the volunteer mothers of the bride and groom exchange the garlands of their volunteer children.

Oti a te 'kāiga 'hoko atu i ai mo lāuga fakapogai tonu mo te pō; tafa atu ki ai ko fakafiafiaga o te āvaga fou, ke oko ailoa ki te fakaafiafi pelā me ko te itulā e fā.

I te otiga o lotu i kāiga i te afiafi, fakatoka atu hoki ailoa i ai mo te 'kāiga. Oti ni inu i te pogipogi koa toe olo i ai a te tama fafine mo tana uosili ki te fale a ona mātua. Oti a fakafiafiaga, koa toe 'foki i ai a te āvaga fou ki te fale o te tagata o 'moe i ai.

Koa tūmau a te faifaiga tenei ke oko ki te pōtapu, telā koa toe fakatoka faka'lei hoki i ai a meakai o te pō nei, me ko te pōtapu muamua o te fakatahiga o te āvaga fou. A te kāiga, fakatahi mo te mātua o te tama fafine koa fakatoka mai hoki ailoa e lātou a te pōtapu o te olotou tamaliki, kae koa 'kai fakatahi katoa ki te fale o te tagata.

"Teu fou, kete fou mo te fafine fou ki loto i te kāiga."

E i ai he fekau me he akoākoga tāua telā e mafai o maua mai i te faifaiga faka Nanumea tenei. I āvaga fou katoa, a te tama fafine e hau ailoa mo tana teu fou, mo tana kete fou, ki te fale o te tagata, telā koa fakaogā mo 'teu a otāota.

Telā lā, koa hē gata ake i te gali mo te 'mā o te matāfale, kae koa gali hoki ailoa mo te tulaga o te kāiga i ona faitu katoa.

Te Niuhihi

Te uiga tonu o te muna tenei niuhihi ko te niu telā e hē hali ki te naifi, ka e hihi ki te hali, kae ko tona uiga e tahi, ko te kete meakai telā koa fakatokagia o avatu ki te fafine, mai te taimi telā koa ono io me koa fitu i ai a ona mahina, ke oko ailoa ki te taimi telā e fānau i ai.

A te niuhihi, he tahi o faigamea faka Nanumea telā e heke mai ai a ia mai fenua o te Tuvalu; he faigamea telā e fakapogai tonu mo te tama ki mua (me he tōkimua) a he fafine. He iloga o te atafai me ko te fugahēle o te tamaliki fafine i ona mātua.

Kamataga o te Niuhihi

E māhani o hihi a te niu a te fafine i te taimi telā koa ono ona mahina (me koa fitu i pō nei). I te kāmataga o te niuhihi, a te fafine faitama e noho ailoa i te fale o te tagata. Ke oko ki te iva mahina o te fafine, koa hau i ai a te mātua o te

After everyone has eaten, speeches focused on the occasion begin. Entertainments follow for the newlywed couple, continuing on until about four in the afternoon.

After evening devotions, food is again served. After breakfast, the bride and her maid of honour return to visit the house of her parents. At the end of the entertainment, the couple returns to groom's house to sleep.

This going back and forth between the houses of the bride and groom continues until Sunday, when a big feast will be carefully prepared by the groom's family because it is the first Sunday of the couple's being together. The bride's family, together with her volunteer mother, also prepare a Sunday meal and carries it over to feast together with the groom's family.

"New broom, new basket, new woman in the family."

There is a message in this Nanumean saying and an important lesson to be gained from it. In any new marriage, the bride brings a new broom and a new tāpola basket with her to the groom's house. She uses the broom to sweep up fallen leaves and other debris around the house.

So, not only should the surroundings of the house be kept nicely by the new bride, she should also look after relationships within the family itself.

The Niuhihi

The real meaning of the word niuhihi is coconut flesh cut from the shell not with a knife, but with a hali (a type of spatula). Another of its meanings is the kete food basket presented to a pregnant woman from the time she is six or seven months pregnant until she gives birth.

The custom of niuhihi distinguishes Nanumea from the other Tuvaluan communities. This special custom is done for a woman's first child. It represents the care and solicitude that parents have for their daughters, especially during pregnancy.

Beginning of the Niuhihi

The niuhihi was always begun when a woman reached her sixth month of pregnancy (seventh month is customary now). During the time that the woman is receiving the niuhihi, her parents and family members try to fulfil any cravings

fafine o puke tana tama fafine mo tana āvaga, ke noho mo ia ke oko ki te taimi e fanau i ai.

Ko te mātua o te fafine koa kāmata e ia o hihi a te niu a tana tama, fakatahi ki ai mo mātua o te tama tagata. Fakamuli ifo, kae fai koa 'logo a kāiga 'pili o te tauluāvaga me koa hihi a te niu a te tama fafine, koa olo i ai a kāiga o te tama fafine ki ona mātua, ke mafai a lātou o fakaholo takitahi a olotou pōtapu o luani ki te niuhihi.

Meakai o te Niuhihi

I pō mua, a meakai o te niuhihi e fai ailoa ki meakai faka te fenua. A ika (te kinaga) e tuku i te laulau fakatahi mo te niu telā koa oti ni hali kae fakafolifoli ki lalo. I pō ono mo pōtapu, e mafai o faulu ni mo mea kiki (pelā me he pōlo fekei io me he pōlo fakalala).

A te pī a te fafine faitama e 'tau o huki faka'lei, kae ke miti muamua e tana āvaga koa tuku i ai ki te fafine ke inu. Kae fai e galo a te tagata, e 'tau o fakamaligi malie a te pī koa inu i ai a te fafine faitama.

Fakataputapuga o te Niuhihi

Kae mailoga i ai ko te fafine telā e hihi a tana niu, e 'tau mo ia o tausi kae atafai ki fakanohoga o te niuhihi, me e i ai he talitonuga e fai pelā me kae fai a koe e hē tausi faka'lei ki fakanohoga o te niuhihi, e mafai o i ai ni pokotiaga koa pokotia i ai a te tamaliki manafai e fānau mai, me i tona taimi tupu ake.

- Ke mo ā e titake a te pī a te fafine, kae ke huki faka'lei ailoa, i te mea mana matapona me mata'pula a te tamaliki mana fanau mai.
- Ke mo ā te moega o te fafine e fai valevale e tama'liki, ke oko hoki ki tino ake, i te mea mana matapona a te tamaliki.
- A te fafine ke hē māhani o kai ki mata o ika (takuo, pāla mo palu) i te mea mana penā a mata o te tamaliki mana fanau mai.
- A te fafine ke hē māhani o vae haele tele me kai valevale i fale o tino, i te mea mana penā hoki a te tamaliki me e matakai.

that she might have. When she is nine months pregnant, her mother will take her and her husband to live with her own family until the time of the birth.

The mother of the pregnant woman begins the niuhihi. Everyday thereafter, both families will prepare a niuhihi for the two of them to eat from. When close relatives of the couple hear that the niuhihi is beginning, they can offer to help with the niuhihi by taking turns one week at a time.

Food of the Niuhihi

Formerly, the food of the niuhihi consisted only of local food. Fish (termed kinaga or 'protein food') is put in a woven platter together with pieces of coconut that have been separated from the shell. On Saturdays and also Sundays, some starch food (such as a small bowl of fekei or fakalala pudding) can be added.

The drinking coconut should be carefully prepared for the young woman to drink and her husband should drink the first sip before it is given to her. If her husband is away at the time, a little of the drinking nut should be poured out before the pregnant woman drinks anything.

Restrictions of the Niuhihi

Women receiving the niuhihi must be especially careful to follow the niuhihi customs, because of the belief that not following them carefully will cause negative effects on the newborn child or on the child as it grows up.

- Make sure that the drinking coconut is not opened from the bottom by hitting with a machete, but only opened at the coconut's proper 'mouth,' lest the child be naughty or have large, bulging eyes when it is born.
- Protect the pregnant woman's bed from being messed up by children and other people, lest her child grow up to be naughty. No one except the pregnant woman should sit on her bedding.
- The pregnant woman should not eat the eyes of the yellow fin tuna, kingfish or castor oil fish lest the child's eyes be like fish eyes when it is born.
- The woman should not roam around or eat in other people's houses lest her child do the same thing, or be greedy.

- E tapu he tino i loto i te kāiga e kai ki te niuhihi. Ko te tauluaāvaga ailoa e kai i ai, kae i te afiāfi, koa taga ke fakaogā e te kāiga meakai toe.
- A te mātua ke hē māhani o gutu naunau ki luma o tino, i te mea mana pokotia hoki i ai a te tamaliki i luma konā.
- A te fāfine faitama, ke hē māhani o suisui me fai ana mea kolosē i te mea mana fui fanau a ia.
- A te pī a te fāfine, kae fai e hē maha, ke tuku ailoa ke fakamahagina e tana āvaga, i te mea mana afu valevale a tamaliki.
- I te taimi tenei koa maumua i ai a te fāfine, a te tagata koa hē 'tau o 'moe fakatahi tele mo tana āvaga.

- Family members are not allowed to eat the niuhihi. When a niuhihi is first presented, only the couple themselves should eat those foods (though at the end of the evening, any leftovers can be used up by the rest of the family).
- The woman must not make fun of the characteristics (or deformities) of people, lest her child be afflicted in the same way.
- The woman must not embroider or crochet lest she have a very difficult time giving birth.
- If a drinking coconut of the new mother is not fully consumed, only her husband should finish it lest her child take after other people.
- A man should not have sex with his wife during the last months of her pregnancy.

Fonu: "Te Ika a Fāfine"

Kae fai e i ai ni tino ni maua he olotou fonu, kae e i ai he fāfine faitama i tona tinae muamua, e 'tau ailoa o 'kave ni ana mo fonu. E aofia i ai a mea konei i loto i te tāpola – fuafonu, kanofi, puku, ginigini toto.

Koa māhani o fai penei me a te fonu he ika e tāua i luga i te fenua kae faigatā hoki o maua valevale. A te tokoukega o tino e fiakai fonu katoa. Telā lā e fakaalofa a te fāfine faitama tenei manafai e fiakai ki te fonu tenei koa maua, kae faigatā ia te ia o fakaali a tana fia kai.

Turtle: "The Fish of Women"

If a community member catches a turtle during the time that a woman is pregnant with her first child, she should be given some of it to eat. Usually, a basket containing all of the various delicacies of the turtle (such as some turtle eggs, some kanofi, some ginigini with turtle blood) is presented to her.

The reason for this is that turtle is a very desired food but one that is very hard to get. Since everyone wants to eat turtle, they empathize with a pregnant woman when a turtle is caught, thinking that she might crave eating it but would be reluctant to ask.

Mātuafo mo Tamafo

He tahi hoki tenei o iloga mai loto o faifaiga faka Nanumea, e lauiloa i ai a ia i loto i fenua o te Tuvalu. A te mātuafo, he fāfine telā e fakatuagane mo te tamana o te tamaliki telā koa fānau mai i tana mātua, ko ia tenei, ni fiafia o ofo ke tausi e ia a te tamaliki.

A te fakamunaga e tahi o te faifaiga tenei, atu lā koa tō leva, kae koa hē fakaaogā mālosi i pō nei, telā ko te mātuafo mo te tamafao.

A "Volunteer Mother" and her "Volunteer Child"

This is also one of the distinctive Nanumean traditions by which the community is known throughout the rest of Tuvalu. A 'volunteer mother' is a woman who is a distant tuagane cousin of the father of a new-born child, who offers her help in caring for the baby.

Another term for this relationship, possibly older but much less commonly used today, is matuafāo and tamafāo.

Te Tuagane-Tapu

Ko te fakatuagane telā koa vā ki te tua-tolu o fano ki luga. A te fāfine telā e manako o ofo a te tama a tana fakatuagane, e māhani o hau i loto

Tuagane Tapu: The Revered Opposite Sex Cousin Relationship

This relationship involves two opposite-sex cousins who are related as third or more distant cousins. A woman wishing to care for (of) the

i te vāhia tenei – ko te tua-tolu ia me ko te tua-fā.

Kae koa 'taku a lāua konei pelā me he tuagane-tapu, me ko te tulaga fakamalumu telā i te vāhia o lāua. I pō nei koa mafai o lavea a te hē tonu o te faifaiga tenei, atu lā e hē motuhia ko te maofa valevale o tāgata Nanumea i te taimi nei.

Fakatokaga a te Mātuafo ki te Fanau mai o te Tamaliki

Kae koi tuai o fānau a te fafine, a ia telā ni mafaufau ke fai a ia mo mātuafo o te tamaliki, koa leva ailoa ni fakatoka ana mea mo te taimi tenā: togi pitāki, pauta, hinu tamaliki, mea katoa ailoa kolā e aogā mo te pepe foliki.

Me ko ia telā e oko muamua atu mo te tipoti vai 'vela, mo ana kope tamaliki, ko ia tenā koa fai mo mātuafo. I pō mua e mafai o tokolua me tokotolu mātuafo o te tamaliki, kae koa oti ni 'fuli ke tokotahi ailoa.

child of her male cousin usually falls within the range of third or fourth cousin.

These two opposite sex cousins are said to be tuagane tapu ('revered cousins') because of the respectful relationship that must be maintained between them henceforth. Nowadays, this custom is not always followed precisely, perhaps because Nanumean people are scattered all over the world.

Preparations Made by the Matuafo Prior to the Birth of the Child

Before the birth, a woman who is planning to be the child's matuafo has already prepared the things needed: diapers, powder, baby oil, and everything else that a little baby needs.

The one who arrives first with a teapot of hot water and her prepared baby gifts normally becomes the matuafo. Formerly, a child could have two or three matuafo but now this is restricted to only one, out of concern for the demands that this relationship makes on the child's father.

Galuega a te Mātuafo

Mai te loto malie o te fafine tenei o ofo ke tausi e ia a te tamaliki a tona fakatuagane, konei lā a galuega koa panaki mo ia i tona tulaga ke fai a ia mo mātuafo:

- Āhi ki te tamaliki i pogipogi mo afiafi o pō katoa o 'mulu pitāki o te tamaliki, tauaki kae auli faka'lei.
- Mai te taimi koa katoa i ai a te mahina o te pepe, a te mātuafo koa mafai o alausu 'malu i pogipogi katoa o ofo a tana tama ke olo mo ia ki tona fale.
- I taimi o pō gatama i tauhaga takitahi, a kāiga katoa e fakatoka faka'lei ailoa a olotou fale, ko lātou lā kolā e i ai ni olotou tamafo, koa puke mai katoa a tamaliki konā ki te fale i te taimi e oti i ai a te lotu-tamaliki, fagai faka'lei.
- Ko te taimi e fai i ai a tana āvaga, telā e lahi 'kī hoki ailoa a te vaega o te mātuafo e fai i te taimi tenei. A fiaiaga o te āvaga ko te toe taimi fakaoti o te mafutaga a te mātuafo mo tana tamafo tagata tenā.

Work of the Matuafo

The generous woman who volunteers to care for the baby of her distant male cousin usually includes these duties in her matuafo role:

- Visit the child in the morning and evening of each day to wash its diapers, dry them and iron them nicely.
- When the baby is a month old, the matuafo should wake up early every morning to take the baby home to her own house. After the baby has visited there a little while, the baby's mother will come over and bring the baby back home again.
- At Children's Day each year, every family prepares their house nicely and all those who have tamafo will bring them to their house after church, feed them well, and give them new clothes and treats before returning them back home. This custom continues until the child has completed primary school (at about age 12).
- The matuafo has major obligations to her tamafo at the time of its wedding. If her child is a man, the wedding celebrations end their relationship.

- Kae fai a tana tamaofo he fafine, a te mātuafo koi faka'hoko ailoa a te tausiga o tana tamaofo (fafine) ke oko ailoa ki te taimi e fānau i ai. E fakatoka hoki e ia a te vene (he fusi loa e 'laga/'fili ki lau fala). A te failele fou tenei, e 'tau o fakaogā a te vene i te ao mo te pō, i loto i te valu mahina.

- If her tamaofo is a woman, however, the matuafo continues her care during the last months of her first pregnancy. She also provides the vene, a long belt woven from pandanus leaves, worn wrapped around the woman's stomach after she has given birth. The new mother should continue to use her vene for eight months, day and night.

Koa Oti ni Fanau a te Tamaliki

Mana fai koa oti ni fānau he tamaliki, a tana mātua mo kau kāiga mai faitu e lua, koa tausi faka'lei katoa ki ai. E i ai hoki he fakamoemoe ko te āvaga a te fafine ke malosī i te faifaiva i pō katoa, mo fai a te fakaomoega o te mātuafo o te tamaliki.

A te tamana e mafai o āhi ki tana āvaga i te ao, kae koa tapu i te 'moe tele mo tana āvaga i te pō. A te mātuafo e āhi tele ki tana tamaofo i te pogipogi mo te afiafi, o pukepuke ki ai kae o 'kave hoki a ona lava mo pitāki pa'leka o 'mulu i te fale.

After the Baby is Born

After any baby is born, its mother and relatives from both sides of its family look after it carefully. For a first baby, however, the new father is expected to go fishing every day to provide the fakaomoega for the baby's matua ofo.

He visits his wife during the day but is forbidden to sleep with her at night. Meanwhile, the matuafo visits her tamaofo morning and night, to hold it and then to take its dirty clothes back home to wash.

Te Fakaomoega

Ko te ōmoe (meakai) a te mātuafo mai tana tamaofo, telā e fai ki ika mo te teaoa niu. A te fakaomoega e māhani o fai ki ika konei – hahave mo te atu. E mafai hoki a ika o te papa, ika o te namo mo fai a te fakaomoega, manafai a vaka koa hē 'tō ki moana me te aho e māhei.

A te tamana koa fakamalosi o faifaiva ke maua a te ōmoe a te mātuafo a tana tama. E gata a te faifaiga tenei, manafai koa hē ofo a te tama, telā e noho pelā ki te ono me ko te valu mahina.

The Fakaomoega

The ōmoe or fakao food gift, given by the child's father on its behalf to its volunteer mother, consists of fish plus a pair of coconuts. Flying fish and tuna are the usual fish given. Reef fish or lagoon fish can also be used for the fakaomoega if canoes cannot go out to sea because of bad weather.

A man who is an energetic fisherman can provide the ōmoe for the volunteer mother of his child by himself. This practice of giving the ōmoe ends when the volunteer mother no longer comes to care for the child, usually when it is about 6 or 8 months old.

Ola o te Fafine mo te Fakahaelega

Kae fai a te mātua fou tenei koa mālosi faka'lei, pelā hoki mo te tamaliki e tuputupu mālosi ailoa, ko te taimi lā tenei koa 'tau i ai o 'toe 'foki a lātou ki te fale o tana āvaga. A te fakatokaga lā o tana toe fakafokiga e taku pelā ko te fakahaelega. Telā ko te fakamanuiaga o te ola manuia o te mātua mo tana pepe i te taimi o te fanaumaiga.

A te mātuafo tenei koa kāmata o teu ki titi mo manogi (fau mo titivao) e tona mātuafo, kae ko tana mātua koa fakatoka faka'lei a te tamaliki. A te mātuafo o te pepe e lākei hoki faka'lei, koa

Te Fakahaelega: Celebration of Survival and Return to Husband's Household

When the new mother is strong and the baby is growing well, it is time for them to return to the household of her husband. The procession to take her there is called the fakahaelega, and is a celebration of the successful birth and good health of mother and baby.

The new mother is adorned with manogi (titi and fau) by her own matua ofo, while her mother gets the baby ready. The matuafo of the baby is also adorned and carries the baby,

puke i ai e ia a te tamaliki telā koa oti ni 'kofu faka'lei ki te pakalua, fakatahi ki ai a te mātuafo o te mātua fou, mo ona kāiga katoa, koa haele mo te 'lifu kae fia'fia o toe 'foki atu ki te fale o te tamana o te tamaliki.

I te okoatuga ki te fale o te tamana o te tamaliki, ni tali fakaalologina a lātou e kāiga o te tagata ki meakai mo meainu, fakatahi mo faigā lāuga mai feitu e lua.

Te Fuamama

Ko te fuamea ia me he mukomuko telā koa tai agatia mālie, e fakaogā a te agati tenei mo fagai a te tamaliki, kae fakamitimiti (fāinu) hoki ki te vainiu o te pī. A te mea tenei ko te meakai muamua ailoa a te tamaliki, mai te taimi koa fakatea i ai mo te ū, kae koi tuai o fai a tana mama ki meakai ake. He tahi o galuega tūmau tenei a te tamana, telā ko te kakega o te fuamama i pō takitahi, mo fāgai a te tamaliki.

Te Kolouni mo te Mama a te Tamaliki

Ko te meakai a te tamaliki mai te taimi telā koa fakatea i ai mo te ū, kae koa fakatautau nei o fāgai ki meakai malūlū pelā mo supu mei, maika pala mo talo fakaholo. Koa oti ni fāgai, koa tuku meakai toe ki he kete foliki mo pukupuku e fakaigoa ki te kolouni.

Kae i te taimi tenā e hau i ai a te mātuafo o ofo a tana tama, e māhani o 'kave mo mama i loto a te kolouni tenā ke olo tahi mo te mātuafo mo fāgai a te pepe i tona fale. A ia mo tino o te kāiga e mafai o fakaaogā (o kai) a te toega o te mama.

carefully covered with a small kapalua mat, and walks together with the new mother and her relatives as a happy group towards the household of the baby's father.

When the procession reaches the house of the baby's father, everyone is invited inside for refreshments. Speakers representing both families make speeches expressing their appreciation and good wishes.

Baby's First Food: The Fuamama

The very soft, sweet jelly inside an immature coconut is used as the first food for a baby. The infant may also be given sips or tastes of the liquid inside a drinking nut. Both these items also serve as the baby's first foods when it is being weaned from the breast, before it is given any other soft foods to eat. Thus, the baby's father must climb a coconut tree each day to get the nuts for the fuamama to feed his child.

The Kolouni: A Gift of Soft Food

After it is weaned from the breast, the baby transitions to eating other soft foods. The soft starchy foods might include breadfruit soup, mashed taro or mashed ripe bananas. The soft food for the child is freshly prepared each day and, after it has first been fed to the child by its own mother, an additional quantity is put in a small round basket called te kolouni.

When the volunteer mother comes to carry the child to visit her own house, she takes that basket of food back home with her to feed the baby in her house. Afterwards, she and her family can eat any of the mama that is left over.